

POWER PLATFORM COMMUNITY CONFERENCE · COMMUNITY THEATER

SWAP THE ENGINE, KEEP THE CAR

Migrating your Copilot Studio agent to GHCP, the GitHub Copilot harness



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THIS CAR TOOK 2 WEEKS TO BUILD.

In the next 20 minutes it gets a new engine. You decide whether it drives better or worse.

TODAY'S ROUTE

WE'LL COVER

- Why the engine (harness) choice matters
- When to swap, and when to keep
- What carries over and what gets rebuilt
- Doing the swap with the plugins

WE WON'T COVER

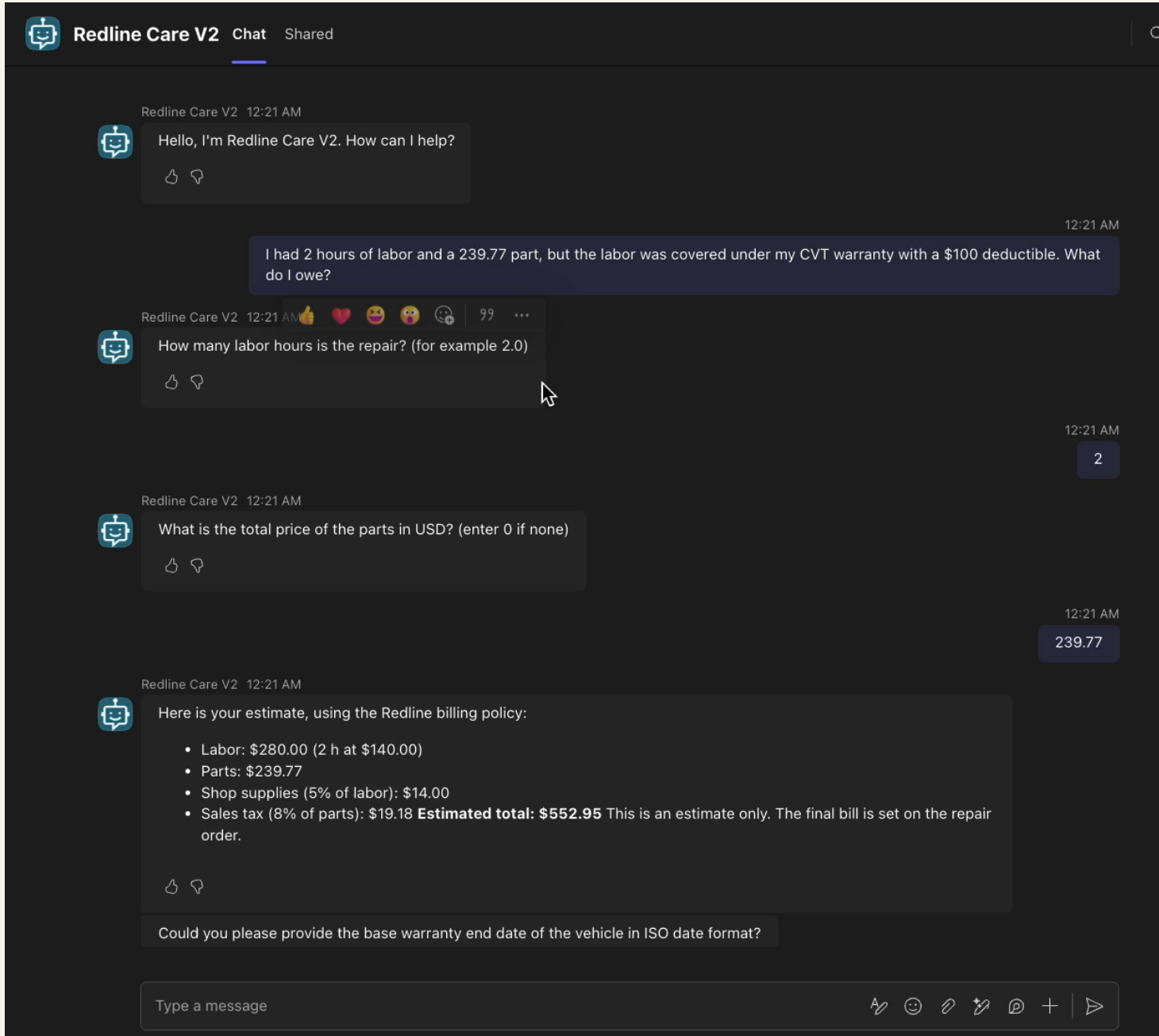
- Licensing
- Governance
- Copilot Credits and cost

MEET THE CAR

Redline Care on the standard harness:

Helps the customer service team answer customer questions.

Our job: keep the car, change the engine.



WHAT'S UNDER THE HOOD?

The model supplies the reasoning. The harness is the engine that decides how it runs.

STANDARD HARNESS

Plan first, then run it

1 INTENT
Understand the request

→

2 PLAN
Build a multi-step workflow

→

3 EXECUTE
Run the authored steps

- You author topics, triggers and branching
- An explicit plan: less live replanning, easier to inspect

GHCP HARNESS

Decide from the latest state, every step

THOUGHT
Reason over the state

→

ACTION
Call a tool or topic

→

OBSERVE
Read the result

→

DECIDE
Pick the next step

- You provide instructions, knowledge, tools, skills
- It loops, and can retry or take another path

Standard fits a path you can map up front. GHCP fits problems you can't, like querying a data model with many unknown fields.

IT'S AN ENGINE SWAP, NOT A BOLT-ON.

Agents can't be transferred between harnesses, in either direction. Even the upgrade tools build a new copy.

DON'T PORT. RE-ARCHITECT.

Upgrade capabilities, not components. Translate what the agent must do into parts that work inside the new loop, instead of copying parts one for one.

THE ONE QUESTION

What tasks must the agent accomplish? Start there, then pick the part that does the job.

SWAP OR KEEP OR BUY A DIFFERENT CAR

Swap for a scenario-level benefit, not because a new engine exists.

SWAP

GHCP HARNESS

- Long-running, multi-step work
- Creates and edits documents
- Skills, memory and parallel work

KEEP

STANDARD HARNESS

- Rule-based intake and routing
- More deterministic processes
- Relies on a channel or feature GHCP may not have yet

DIFFERENT CAR

CUSTOMER CONVERSATION HARNESS

- Customer chat or voice
- Escalates to a human representative
- Website chat or a phone number

WHAT CARRIES OVER

Standard harness	GHCP harness
Instructions	Instructions (carried over)
Actions and connectors	Tools (carried over)
Agent flows: repeatable multi-connector steps	Workflow or agent flow tool, kept when order and side effects matter
Power Fx: inline logic and data shaping	A skill, with a script when the result must be exact
Topics that must run identically	Workflows
Topics that encode know-how	Skills
Child agents	A skill or a connected agent
Adaptive Cards: a fixed card experience	No direct twin. Ask what the card is for
Knowledge sources	Knowledge
Variables and remembered context	Memory (preview)

New parts with no old twin: **Hooks**, which trigger behavior for code-first workflows.

TWO WAYS TO DO THE SWAP

PREVIEW

IN-PORTAL UPGRADE: THE DEALERSHIP

- Go to copilotstudio.preview.microsoft.com and on the home page ask Copilot Studio to upgrade the agent
- Builds a copy on the new harness
- Carries instructions, tools, suggested prompts
- Topics can be rebuilt as skills or workflows
- Report: migrated, needs attention, skipped

TODAY'S DEMO

PLUGIN PLUS GITHUB COPILOT/ CLAUDE CODE: YOUR OWN GARAGE

- Pulls the agent into your workspace
- Analyzes it and proposes a new design
- You steer it with constraints
- Local files you can diff and review
- Builds an upgraded agent to test

THE SWAP, STEP BY STEP

1 · STOCK UP

The plugin for your AI coding assistant, plus Power Platform CLI 2.9.3 or newer.

2 · PLACE THE ORDER

Send the environment, tenant and agent URL, plus any constraints.

3 · INSPECT THE PLAN

It proposes a new architecture. Review it before you trust it.

```
/plugin marketplace add microsoft/power-platform-skills
/plugin install power-automate@power-platform-skills
/plugin install dataverse@power-platform-skills
/plugin marketplace add microsoft/copilot-studio-plugin
/plugin install mcs-assistant@copilot-studio-plugin
/mcs-assistant:migrate Upgrade this agent to the GitHub Copilot harness: [agent URL] from tenant [tenant ID]. Use a capable AI model.
```

DEMO

Standard agent in. GHCP harness agent out.

/mcs-assistant:migrate Redline Care V2 source

This run picks up where the last one stopped. The checks, clone, target workspace, description and action inventory are all done, and no plan file was written because the plan wasn't approved. So here is the full plan again for your decision.

What the new agent is for

A GHCP-harness version of Redline Care, the service-department assistant for Redline Motors. It checks customers' vehicles, explains repair order bills, decides warranty coverage and credits, and checks parts and open service slots. It uses only tool and knowledge data, and sends sales and legal requests to the service desk at 555-0100.

Capabilities the new agent will have

Approving this plan makes these the migrated agent's capabilities.

Capability	Behavior
Identifies a customer and their vehicles	Asks for the email first, then returns each vehicle's VIN, model, mileage, in-service date and warranty facts. It reports facts only.
Retrieves a repair order	Asks for the RO number and reads every line, without dropping or totalling any.
Decides warranty coverage	Hands the vehicle facts and repair to the Warranty Specialist, which uses only the Vantis booklet. It checks the base warranty and the CVT extension separately, and whichever limit hits first applies.
Calculates the warranty credit	Takes covered labor, covered parts, original total and deductible. Supplies are 5% of covered labor and tax is 8% of covered parts. It then gives the corrected total and the credit.
Estimates a repair bill	Takes labor hours and a parts total. It applies the billing policy: $140.00 an hour, supplies 5% of labor, tax 8% of parts.
Checks part availability	Reports in stock or backordered, with the expected date and price.
Finds open service slots	Lists unbooked slots by service type, soonest first. It is read-only and never offers a date before a backordered part arrives.
Answers billing-policy questions	Answers from the billing policy document only, with no web search or guessing.
Declines out-of-scope requests	Sends buying, negotiating and legal requests to 555-0100.

Tool and action decisions

Needs your input

Type / for commands

Auto

Sonnet 5.5 Medium

Environment

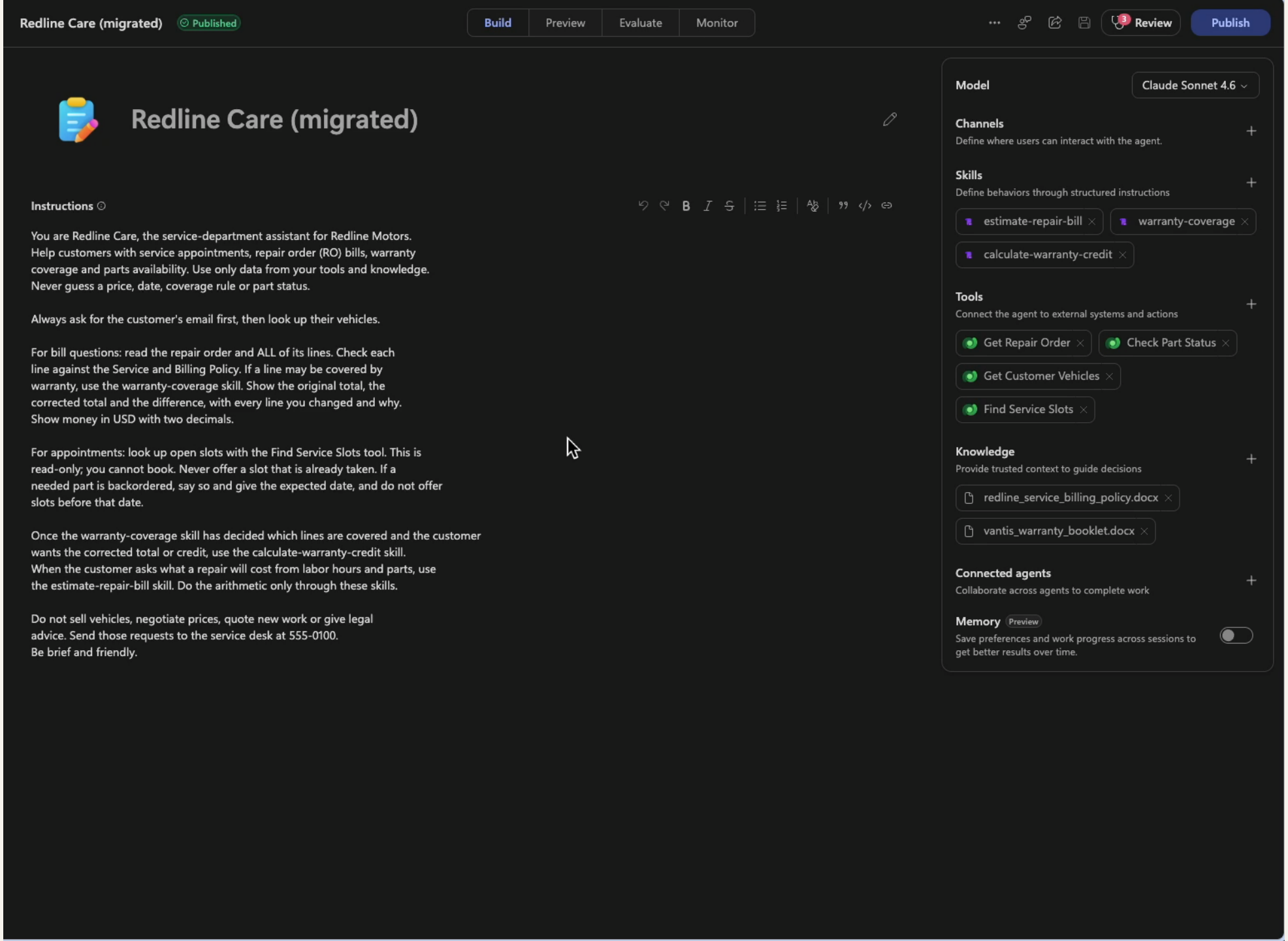
This computer Save

ppcc-demo · ~

Remote Control

Context 23%

Connectors 21 connected


Redline Care (migrated)
Published
Build
Preview
Evaluate
Monitor
Review
Publish
Redline Care (migrated)
Instructions
You are Redline Care, the service-department assistant for Redline Motors. Help customers with service appointments, repair order (RO) bills, warranty coverage and parts availability. Use only data from your tools and knowledge. Never guess a price, date, coverage rule or part status.
Always ask for the customer's email first, then look up their vehicles.
For bill questions: read the repair order and ALL of its lines. Check each line against the Service and Billing Policy. If a line may be covered by warranty, use the warranty-coverage skill. Show the original total, the corrected total and the difference, with every line you changed and why. Show money in USD with two decimals.
For appointments: look up open slots with the Find Service Slots tool. This is read-only; you cannot book. Never offer a slot that is already taken. If a needed part is backordered, say so and give the expected date, and do not offer slots before that date.
Once the warranty-coverage skill has decided which lines are covered and the customer wants the corrected total or credit, use the calculate-warranty-credit skill.
When the customer asks what a repair will cost from labor hours and parts, use the estimate-repair-bill skill. Do the arithmetic only through these skills.
Do not sell vehicles, negotiate prices, quote new work or give legal advice. Send those requests to the service desk at 555-0100.
Be brief and friendly.
Model
Claude Sonnet 4.6
Channels
Define where users can interact with the agent.
Skills
Define behaviors through structured instructions
estimate-repair-bill
warranty-coverage
calculate-warranty-credit
Tools
Connect the agent to external systems and actions
Get Repair Order
Check Part Status
Get Customer Vehicles
Find Service Slots
Knowledge
Provide trusted context to guide decisions
redline_service_billing_policy.docx
vantis_warranty_booklet.docx
Connected agents
Collaborate across agents to complete work
Memory
Preview
Save preferences and work progress across sessions to get better results over time.

YOUR PRE-SWAP CHECKLIST

1. Name the benefit you’re after
2. Baseline the old engine with a test set
3. Inventory intent, not parts
4. Run the swap with constraints
5. Inspect the output like code
6. Test drive old and new side by side

THE TEST OF DONE

The rebuilt agent handles your core journeys. It doesn’t need every old part.

THANK YOU!